

**Rockingham County Schools
Board of Education
Central Administrative Offices
511 Harrington Highway
Eden, NC 27288**

**June 09, 2025
Regular Board Meeting
6:00 p.m.**

Open Session Minutes

Present: Ms. Paula Rakestraw, Board Chair and Ms. Kimberly McMichael, Vice Chair. Board Members: Ms. Vicky Alston, Mr. Philip Butler, Ms. Vickie McKinney, Mr. Daniel Rakes and Mr. Bob Wyatt. Administrative staff: Dr. Shawn Stover, Superintendent; Dr. Charles Perkins, Assistant Superintendent of Curriculum and Instruction; Dr. Cindy Corcoran, Assistant Superintendent of Support Services; Ms. Erselle Young, Assistant Superintendent of Operations and Logistics; Ms. Annie Ellis, Chief Financial Officer; Mr. Lowell Rogers, Executive Director of Human Resources; Mr. Brandon McPherson, Board Attorney and Ms. Renee Brown, Board Assistant were present.

CALL TO ORDER

Ms. Rakestraw called the meeting to order.

ROLL CALL

The Board members stated their names. Seven members were present at roll call.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

Ms. Rakestraw announced there is no Work Session scheduled in June.

Ms. Rakestraw announced there is a Special Called Board Meeting scheduled for Wednesday, June 25, 2025 at 9:00 a.m. The Special Called Meeting is for approval of year-end budget amendments to close out the 2024-2025 school year.

Ms. Rakestraw announced that the next Board Meeting is scheduled for Monday, July 14, 2025. The meeting begins at 6:00 p.m. at Central Administrative Offices at 511 Harrington Highway, Eden, NC.

The Rockingham County Board of Education (BOE) is aware of rumors circulating in the community and on social media suggesting that Rockingham County Schools (RCS) is removing School Resource Officers (SROs) from our schools. The Board has issued the following statement to clarify and address these concerns:

[Read the full statement here.](#)

MOMENT OF PRAYER

Pastor James Tharrington, Evangel Fellowship Reidsville Church of God in Christ, Reidsville, NC, gave the invocation.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mr. Wyatt led the pledge of allegiance.

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

Ms. Alston moved to approve the agenda, seconded by Mr. Rakes. The vote was 7/0 Unanimously Approved.

RECOGNITIONS

Dr. Stover and Dr. Perkins recognized Ms. Cuthbertson as the RCS District Secondary Math Teacher of the Year for her outstanding contributions to mathematics education.

PUBLIC COMMENTS / BOARD COMMENTS

- **Board Attorney Mr. McPherson read Board Policy 2310: Public Participation at Board Meetings, outlining the guidelines and expectations for public engagement during board meetings.**

Public Comments:

1. Shannon Dewalt
2. Commissioner Kevin Berger

Board Members Made Comments

Ms. Rakestraw explained that the items on the Consent Agenda are considered non-controversial. However, she encouraged anyone with questions to reach out to staff for further clarification.

CONSENT AGENDA

Presented consent items for Board consideration:

1. Approval Consent - Gifts, Grants and Donations - Ms. Annie Ellis
2. Approval Consent - Head Start Program Monthly Budget Update - Ms. Annie Ellis
3. Approval Consent - Budget Amendments - Ms. Annie Ellis
4. Approval Consent - School Accident & Athletic Insurance Coverage Fiscal Year 2025-2026 - Ms. Annie Ellis
5. Approval Consent - Adoption of Board Policies - Dr. Cindy Corcoran
6. Approval Consent - Partnerships/Contracts with Rockingham County Exceptional Children's Department - Dr. Cindy Corcoran and Dr. Star Norton
7. Approval Consent - 2025-2026 RCS Procurement Plan for the School Nutrition Program - Ms. Shakiva Robinson
8. Approval Consent - CTE Plan (CLNA) for 2025-2026 - Ms. Nina Walls
9. Approval Consent - Errors and Omissions General Liability Insurance - Fleet Insurance, Workers' Compensation Insurance Renewal with NC School Boards Trust - Ms. Annie Ellis
10. Approval Consent - Open Session Board Minutes:
May 07, 2025 - Special Called Board Meeting
May 12, 2025 - Regular Board Meeting

Action: Mr. Rakes moved that the Board approve the consent items as presented. Ms. McKinney seconded the motion. The vote was 7/0. Unanimously Approved.

ACTION ITEMS

Approval - Interim Budget Resolution July 1, 2025 thru October 31, 2025 - Ms. Annie Ellis

Ms. Rakestraw recognized Ms. Annie Ellis, who presented the 2025–2026 Interim Budget Resolution for the period of July 1, 2025 through October 31, 2025. She explained that the figures in the resolution are based on expenditures from July through November of the previous fiscal year (2024), and emphasized that the interim budget is necessary because the final budget will not be adopted by July 1, 2025. Ms. Ellis noted that once the final budget is approved, it will supersede the interim budget. **(Attachment 1-A)**

Action: Mr. Wyatt moved that the Board approve the interim budget resolution as presented. Ms. Alston seconded the motion. The vote was 7/0. Unanimously Approved.

Approval - Increase in the Fee-for-Service Cost for RCS Preschool Program 2025-2026 - Dr. Cindy Corcoran

Ms. Rakestraw recognized Dr. Corcoran, who presented a proposal regarding the RCS Preschool Program. Dr. Corcoran informed the Board that the program is requesting approval to increase the Fee-For-Service costs for preschool parents from \$450 to \$500 per month, effective August 2025. Additionally, the proposal includes a one-time registration and supplies fee of \$75. Dr. Corcoran noted that these changes are necessary to support the operational needs of the program. Board members asked questions and commented on the information presented. **(Attachment 2-A)**

Action: Ms. McMichael moved to approve to increase the Fee-For-Service costs for preschool parents as presented. Mr. Rakes seconded the motion. The vote was 7/0. Unanimously Approved.

REPORTS/DISCUSSION ITEMS

Revised 2025-2026 Calendars - Dr. Charles Perkins

Ms. Rakestraw recognized Dr. Perkins for the revised 2025-2026 calendars. Dr. Perkins presented the revised draft calendars for the 2025–2026 school year, including Traditional, Dillard Academy, and Early College/CTE Innovative High School. The calendars will be posted for public review and comments.

Key updates include changes to early release and workdays, resulting in:

- Traditional: 168 student days, 215 staff days
- Dillard: 172 student days, 215 staff days
- Early College/CTE: 175 student days, 215 staff days

These revisions align with calendar law and year-round instructional requirements. **(Attachment 3-A)**

Committee Reports

- Facilities Committee - Presented by Mr. Butler

Mr. Butler presented the Facilities Committee Report, outlining ongoing and upcoming capital improvement projects throughout the district. He emphasized the committee's continued focus on prioritizing facility upgrades that support safe, efficient, and high-quality learning environments. The report included updates on planning, funding, and project timelines.

Superintendent's Report

Ms. Rakestraw recognized Dr. Stover for the Superintendent's Report. Dr. Stover gave a Budget Update during his Superintendent's Report for the 2025–26 school year, highlighting a projected shortfall of \$2–\$3 million from the approved budget, driven by declining enrollment and increasing costs. The district expects to receive approximately \$2.3 million less in state funding due to a projected drop of 278 students.

To address the deficit, proposed actions include:

- Adjusting staffing allotments
- Shifting to a 168-day instructional calendar
- Closing Parent Resource Centers
- Moving central office salaries to federal funding
- Funding the energy contract from capital funds

Estimated savings from these measures total over \$2.4 million. Additional potential cuts were outlined if needed, including reductions in counseling staff and central office discretionary spending.

Dr. Stover stressed the need for proactive fiscal planning, ongoing stakeholder engagement, and transitioning to a continuous budgeting mindset. Board members asked questions and commented on the information presented. (**Attachment 4-A**)

The Board took a ten-minute break at 7:48 p.m.

CLOSED SESSION

Action: Mr. Butler moved for the Rockingham County Board of Education to enter Closed Session, to discuss confidential personnel information, pursuant to N.C. General Statute §143-318.11(a)(1), and (a)(6), and to consult with the Board's attorney in order to preserve the attorney-client privilege, pursuant to N.C. General Statute §143.318.11(a)(3). Ms. McKinney seconded the motion. The motion carried on a vote of 7/0. The Board moved into closed session at 7:58 p.m.

Action: Ms. McKinney moved to return to open session, seconded by Mr. Butler. The motion carried on a vote of 7/0.

Mr. Lowell Rogers presented the Personnel Report during the closed session. Please refer to (Attachment 5 -A) for further details.

Action: Mr. Rakes moved to accept the personnel report as presented. Seconded by Ms. McKinney, motion carried on a vote of 7/0.

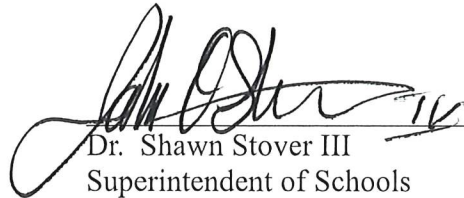
Action: Mr. Rakes moved to accept the RCS Out of County Release as presented. Seconded by Ms. McMichael, motion carried on a vote of 7/0.

Action: Ms. Alston moved to adjourn, seconded by Ms. McMichael. The vote passed 7/0.

Minutes read and approved:



Ms. Paula Rakestraw, Board Chair
Rockingham County Board of Education



Dr. Shawn Stover III
Superintendent of Schools

July 14, 2025

